



The Selectboard
TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON
TOWN HALL
1 SOUTH ROAD
WESTHAMPTON, MASSACHUSETTS 01027

MINUTES of the MEETING
Monday, March 25, 2024, at 7:00 PM

The Westhampton Selectboard scheduled a regular meeting to be held on Monday, March 25, 2024, at 7:00 PM at the Town Offices, 1 South Road.

Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 7:00 PM

Present: Maureen Dempsey, Chair; Scott Johndrow, Susan Bronstein.

Others Present: Douglas Finn; others as noted.

Ms. Dempsey welcomed Mr. Ryan Brooks, who was attending as part of his Communications merit badge.

General Business

TENTATIVE: PRESENTATION / DISCUSSION – LIBRARY TRUSTEES

Westhampton Library Garden Accessibility Plan

Ms. Andrea Pichette presented a proposed plan, prepared by the Conway School of Design, that would improve accessibility on the lawn behind (to the east) of the Library. Ms. Pichette noted that the proposal was started by a “Friends of the Library” project, not the trustees, but that the Trustees were considering the plan. The proposal originated from a local community survey that emphasized easier access to the lawn by folks of limited mobility.

The plan was reviewed.

The plan as presented as two options – walkway from the main parking lot across the north-side of the lot, as well as across the south side of the lot.

Ms. Pichette noted that the part of the plan showing a new ADA compliant access to the back lawn from the north side of the parking lot to the lawn area is proposed.

After further review, the board generally agreed that the Trustees should continue to work collaboratively with the “Friends” to select a designer, in order to prepare formal designs, a scope of work, and estimated cost.

TOWN MEETING WARRANT

The warrant (draft) was reviewed. Mr. Finn noted changes or additions, and that the warrant would “close” on Wednesday, 3/27/2024, in accordance with Town Bylaw.

Further review was tabled to a later meeting.

TOWN CAUCUS WARRANT

After review, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve the warrant, and to sign.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:17 PM)

PRESENTATION / VOTE – ARPA

Mr. Johndrow noted receipt of a request from the Elementary School for generator servicing and repairs. Mr. Johndrow noted that the documents received did not contain sufficient information, and that he would like to table the matter to the next regular meeting.

HREPC JOINT PROCLAMATION

After review, it was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Bronstein

To approve the proclamation and authorize Ms. Dempsey to sign.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:23 PM)

Department Reports

Highway

Mr. Jablonski noted recent work, particularly in relation to the weekend's ice storm, significant downed tree limbs, some plowing of snow, and treatment of roads; he noted the difficulty of dealing with ice on non-frozen dirt roads.

General Discussion - Rain Runoff/ Erosion onto Public Ways (156 North Rd)

Mr. Jablonski noted that the situation seemed to be a neighborhood dispute; there was little that the Town could do, as no rules allowed the town to enforce action on either party.

After discussion it was agreed that Mr. Finn would draft a letter to the property owner, asking them to address the matter.

Health

Ms. Bachelor reported on recent activities relative to opioid prevention, treatment and awareness.

Ms. Bachelor also noted that tick-pullers and (potentially) thermometers might be available for public distribution. Covid-19 test kits may not be available.

Ms. Bachelor noted that the Foothills Health District is looking for office space.

Ms. Bachelor noted that the CDC has released new guidelines relative to Covid-19 – whether masks are required or optional, whether isolation is even required.

Fire Department – Chief David Antosz

Chief Antosz noted that the work on the Expedition was complete, and under budget. He noted that replacement lights would exceed the cost of the bodywork; a second source of lighting has been procured at a lower cost; other details (reflective striping, door lettering) is ongoing.

Chief Antosz also noted that Engine 2 is 40 years old, and that he would like permission to seek out Federal grant funds for its replacement. The hope would be a grant of \$500,000 - \$560,000, leaving the remainder of the cost to the Town (estimated to be \$65,000 to \$85,000)

Public Comment

Paul Goyette and Aaron Bauer spoke briefly about the possibility of an off-road motorcycle event on Sunday, June 30 behind 360 Main Road. There was some discussion about safety, emergency response, traffic, food service, sanitary services, and etc. The applicants were advised to stay in touch with town officials, reach out to necessary departments.

Administrative Business

Administrative Update

Mr. Finn provided brief administrative updates. Mr. Finn asked if he should continue to pursue a formal IFB for solar on town buildings; he was advised to prepare a report for the Master Plan Implementation Committee, and allow them to review all materials. There was some discussion relative to the Elementary School budget as approved by the School Committee. No action taken.

Review Correspondence

The board reviewed one letter from Janet at the Foothills Health District, requesting information about any available office space. No action taken.

Review and Sign: Payroll and A/P Warrants: W24-20, WP24-20

After review, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve Warrants W24-20 and WP24-20, and to sign.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (8:12 PM)

Review and Sign: Minutes from Previous Meetings

The minutes of March 11, 2024 were reviewed.

It was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Bronstein

To approve the minutes as presented.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (8:13 PM)

Set date for next meetings –

The following upcoming meetings or events were noted:

- Town Caucus – April 8, 2024, 6 PM
- Regular Meeting - April 8, 2024, 7 PM
- Regular Meeting - April 22, 2024, 7 PM

Executive Session

It was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Johndrow;

To enter into executive session for the purposes of approving minutes from a previous executive session, and to discuss matters relative to pending litigation.

VOTED: JOHNDROW – YES; BRONSTEIN – YES; DEMPSEY – YES.

The board entered executive session at 8:16 PM.

Executive Session

ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, it was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Bronstein

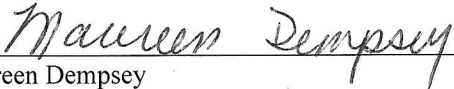
To exit Executive Session and immediately to adjourn.

VOTED: JOHNDROW – YES; BRONSTEIN – YES; DEMPSEY – YES. (8:26 PM)

Respectfully submitted,

Douglas C. Finn

Approved by a vote of the Selectboard at a regular meeting, held on April 8, 2024.


Maureen Dempsey


Scott Johndrow


Susan Bronstein